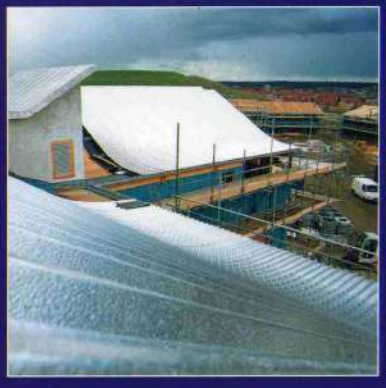






GALLIONS
HOUSING
ASSOCIATION

ANNUAL REVIEW 2001/02







Gallions' Policies and Procedures

We aim to meet the needs and expectations of our customers and service users, and provide quality services through well documented policies, procedures and standards.

We have produced a comprehensive, on-line policy and procedure manual which includes tenant rights, timescales and targets. It provides easy and instant access for staff and residents to policies, procedures and supporting documents.

These policies and procedures have been developed, in consultation with the Policies and Procedures Committee and the Board, by identifying, organising and sharing information on good practice across all housing sectors.

Chief Executive's Statement

I am pleased to report a year of considerable progress since our last annual report. Our vision, shared by others in the local community, is to see Thamesmead as an area where the homes, environment and quality of life are so attractive that it will become a place of 'first choice' for those seeking housing.

This vision drives everything that we do, and we are beginning to see real progress and real benefits for the local community. Our partnerships with local authorities, community groups and the police have resulted in campaigns such as the Clean Sweep initiative, community safety and neighbourhood wardens, which have produced immediate results in the area. Our concern for the local environment has led to the creation of 'Team Gallions', our environmental and landscape team, whose work has been complimented by many residents.

Our desire to work with the local community is another feature of our approach which has produced positive results: after school homework clubs, Audio X – a recording studio for young people – and Trees for Thamesmead.

New housing developments for existing and future generations are another area of major change this year. Gallions now has over 300 homes in the pipeline, including our attractive and innovative EcoPark development. Our recognition as a quality social landlord has been endorsed by the Housing Corporation with the award of a £5m grant to provide new homes in the area.

Our strength is that we are a local organisation working in partnership with the community. Our successes during the past year demonstrate what we can achieve in a relatively short space of time. However, we are not prepared to be complacent – past success only serves to show what can be done, and we look forward to developing even more new initiatives that will build on our vision for Thamesmead as a place of choice and quality.



Tony Cotter

our *new vision* for Thamesmead

Gallions will pursue a policy of excellence in the provision of housing needs and, where appropriate, contribute to community regeneration



Gallions aims to provide the very best service for its customers by:

- seeking to work in partnership with all stakeholders
- striving for a high level of resident involvement in the services the Association delivers
- encouraging a culture of flexibility so as to accommodate change
- being financially robust
- continuing to seek effectiveness and efficiency in all aspects of its business

Gallions' core values, which underpin all of its activities, are:

Integrity and openness

Gallions will operate according to the highest standards of integrity, honesty and openness, and will deliver on its promises.

Customer service

Gallions' activities will always be driven by this central value, listening to and working with our customers, continually reviewing the service to ensure that it is focussed on the customer and of a consistent, high quality.

Being a good employer - Gallions recognises the value of a well motivated and highly skilled staff team that receives good information from the organisation, receives good quality, focussed training and that is engaged in decision making processes where possible.



Partnerships

Within Thamesmead Gallions operates across two Boroughs. The value of working in partnership and building partnerships to benefit the service provided to residents has already been demonstrated. Gallions wishes to build on this fact in order to have a greater impact in its activities.

Working with residents Gallions recognises the value of good two-way communication with residents and encouraging genuine involvement to achieve improvements in service and other areas.

Community safety This is an important issue for Gallions residents, which has an impact on the perception of Thamesmead as a place to live and of Gallions as a landlord. Gallions' commitment to community safety influences all its activities.

Equality and diversity Thamesmead is a diverse community, and Gallions values the advantages that this brings to the local and wider population. Gallions promotes equality and fairness and seeks to support and encourage respect for diversity.

Innovation and continual improvement – Gallions is a forward-looking organisation that is always open to challenging its existing practices and seeking out better ways of working, not only within the UK but across Europe.

Thamesmead – a place of *choice*

Gallions intends to help make Thamesmead a 'Place of Choice' that will:

- make the most of its potential – river, green space, development sites, location and improving transport links
- generate self-sustaining development and investment, not calling on special public-sector support
- offer a range of jobs, in growing sectors not declining ones, with a good local skill base to recruit from
- be full of things to do, to entertain residents, visitors and young people
- be a name on the map of London that attracts people, just like Greenwich, Richmond or Wanstead.



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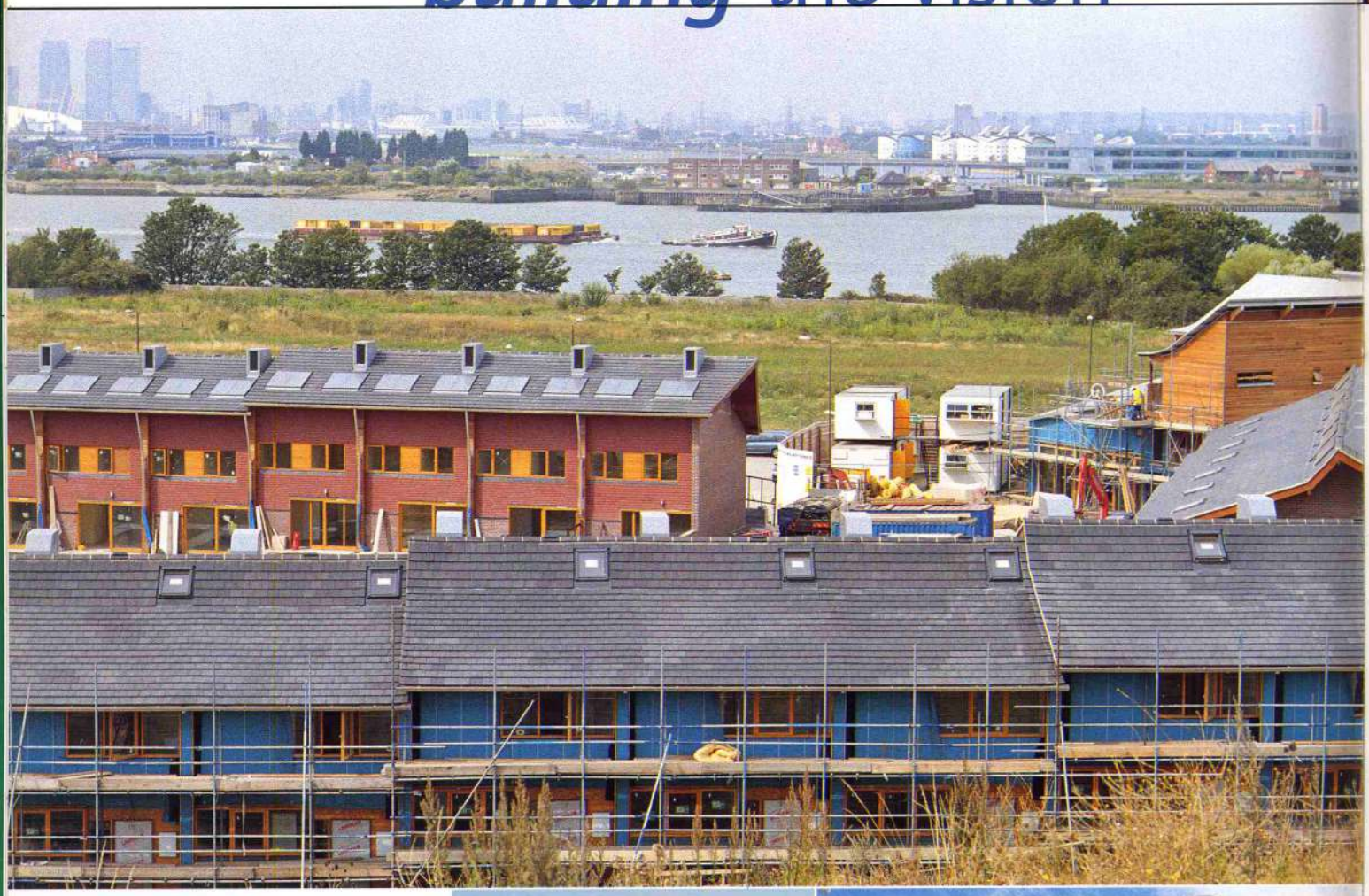






Gallions sees Thamesmead growing into "a well connected, distinct and vibrant part of London, located on the Thames, an oasis in Greater London of quality landscape, inland waterways and much green space. A place that is vibrant and self sustaining, a place of quality, the pride of residents, attractive to visitors and a model of 21st century living, working and playing."

building the vision



This year has seen a considerable increase in activity as the Development department has built on preparations made in previous years.

At the end of the year, we have four projects in construction that will provide 128 new homes, showing real progress towards our goal of providing more affordable housing to those in need.













Ecopark

Due for completion in November 2002, Ecopark has attracted much attention for its environmentally sustainable and striking design. This Dutch-inspired project of 39 houses will incorporate a Visitors' Centre for its first year to showcase its sustainable features. Ecopark has received Demonstration Project status from the Housing Forum, an Innovation and Good Practice Grant from our regulator, the Housing Corporation, and will gain an 'Excellent' rating from the Building Research Establishment 'Eco-Homes' assessment.

A highly successful launch took place on 5 November 2001 attended by John Austin MP and local councillors from the London Boroughs of Greenwich and Bexley, along with local, trade and national press and industry professionals. The launch was hosted by television presenter Tony Robinson and included major music and drama contributions from St John Fisher and Linton Mead schools, reflecting their views on the environment. Their artwork can also be seen around the site.

The project has attracted considerable interest from the media, including Dutch national newspapers and Radio 4's Today Programme. The Visitor Centre is due to open in December 2002 with an educational and fun interactive exhibition. A full programme of visits and seminars is also planned. The Ecopark project is a real example of Gallions' vision for the future of housing.

Partnerships

Gallions continues to build partnerships with social housing organisations in the rest of Europe, in order to share examples of best practice and information on the most up-to-date technology. One such relationship is with the eight-nation RegenLink project, aimed at sharing ideas on sustainable construction and energy conservation in existing buildings. This can bring real benefits for residents in the form of reduced fuel bills for heating, and it is an area where we have much to learn from Europe. Our own project involves installing significantly improved insulation and glazing, and a new ultra-efficient heating system to replace the District Heating System at Sanderling Court.

Development team members are also participating in a series of meetings with development colleagues from France, Sweden and Holland, exchanging ideas and examples of practice with the aim of delivering the best value in new build and refurbishment for our residents.

Development Sites

As well as EcoPark, other sites under construction are at Grovelands in the Urban village, Gunnery Fields and Greenacres near the Town Centre. Greenacres is the first project by Gallions to feature shared-ownership housing, and responds to an identified need in Thamesmead, with six 2-bedroom flats available in early 2003.

Pipeline schemes have been identified which will provide many hundreds more homes for those in need during the coming months and years. Responding again to local demand, the department is exploring other forms of tenure and provision. Working with partners, we intend to establish homes for key workers, more sheltered units, housing specifically tailored to ethnic minority communities and diverse forms of low-cost home ownership.

Funding

2002 was a landmark year for Gallions in that it bid for, and received, its first allocation of funding from the Housing Corporation. The site receiving the grant is at Collingtree Park, and securing nearly £2.5m against the first phase of this scheme establishes Gallions as a truly 'developing' landlord. The support of the London Borough of Greenwich in the bid made a positive difference, and we hope to build on this support in the future. The Collingtree scheme is also a first in that it is being built in partnership with Ujima HA, which will own and manage 17 of the 86 units in the completed development.

The year has also seen:

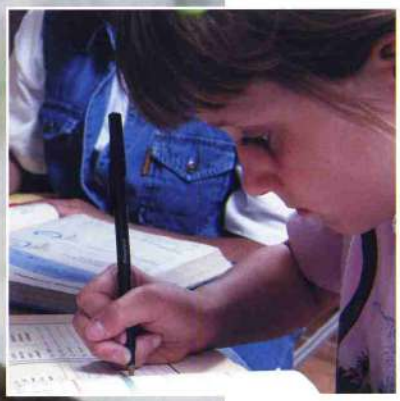
- the establishment of a framework to facilitate Egan Compliance through partnering, benchmarking and the use of Key Performance Indicators. This work is important to Gallions as not only is compliance required by our regulator, but it offers savings in cost and time, will improve predictability and quality (through supply chain management) and reduce waste.
- membership of the Construction Clients Charter to improve working practices.
- membership of the Generating Solar Homes strategy group.
- the setting of a new development strategy to build on past and current success and maximise opportunity throughout Thamesmead.

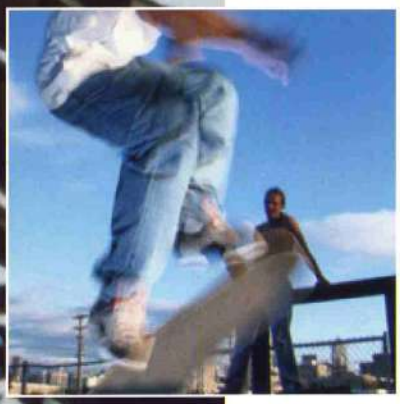
working with the next generation











Audio X

In order to provide constructive activities for disaffected young people in Thamesmead, we began working with Trust Thamesmead and In-Volve (a specialist youth agency) to develop an exciting project called Audio X. Young people aged between 16 and 25 now have the opportunity to work with the latest music production software in a supported environment. They are also able to gain a London Open College Network College qualification and get assistance to enter further training or employment opportunities. Younger people aged 13-16 will be able to attend special sessions run by an experienced trainer to experiment with the music software. This innovative project is managed by In-Volve and is based in the old Millennium music studios at Gallion's offices. Look out for some serious musical talent coming from Thamesmead in the future!

Young people and the Environment

Gallions recognises the importance of building young people's commitment and sense of pride in the local environment. In May 2002, at the same time as the new Team Gallions service was introduced, we launched our Environment Rangers scheme. Designed in partnership with Greenwich and Bexley Boroughs, it provided local junior school children with a 'cool' pack which includes a brochure explaining how to care for the local environment. The pack tells kids what to do if they notice, for example, graffiti, dog mess or a street lamp out of order. The Environment Rangers were asked to report these on Gallions' freephone number. All calls from Rangers are monitored, and at the end of the year the school that has had the most Environment Rangers reports will receive a grant of £500 from Gallions. We are applying for grant funding to extend this scheme so that we can continue the work with school children over the next three years and also address graffiti across Thamesmead.

The next generation's reality

We are planning to install a skate park, designed by young people working with a specialist contractor, to provide a safe and well-lit activity for young people.

To complement this project we hope to build a pilot graffiti wall to encourage local artists to display their work in a designated and safe environment.

Gallions staff will also be volunteering a small amount of their time each week to assist local primary school pupils with their reading and maths. We will be supporting the establishment of two after-school clubs and a homework club in Thamesmead, and working with partner organisations to ensure that our sporting facilities are well maintained and used.

living in Thamesmead

Gallions is helping to make Thamesmead a thriving, diverse, sustainable community





Gallions is committed to the regeneration of Thamesmead because it is an area that faces some significant social and economic challenges. As the major social landlord in Thamesmead, we believe we have a duty to make sure these challenges are overcome and to build on the many strengths and opportunities that exist within the community.

Our goal is to encourage people to remain living in Thamesmead because they have access to all the facilities they require, because they get support from their neighbours and because they feel safe and comfortable in their homes.

We want to support residents who have specific needs so that they can feel valued members of our community. We also want to attract new people to come and live in Thamesmead out of choice.

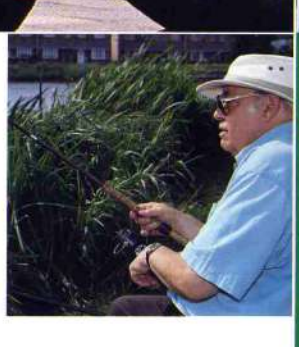
In order to help Gallions achieve this goal, we established our **Community Renewal Team** in September 2001.
In the long term, we will develop a Community Renewal Strategy to set out how Gallions will help ensure that Thamesmead is a place where people enjoy living and working. We have asked a specialist consultancy called Renaisi to develop the strategy, and they are running a series of consultation events and a community survey to identify residents' priorities.

We will then be able to prioritise the particular needs of people living in Thamesmead and ensure that we take up the opportunities that exist to build on community strengths.









community safety partnership

There have been a number of positive changes over the past year in the area of Community Safety.

Developing meaningful partnerships can be a lengthy process, requiring the nurturing of relationships between organisations that often work in very different ways. Nonetheless, Gallions Housing Association has already managed to secure two key projects involving collaboration





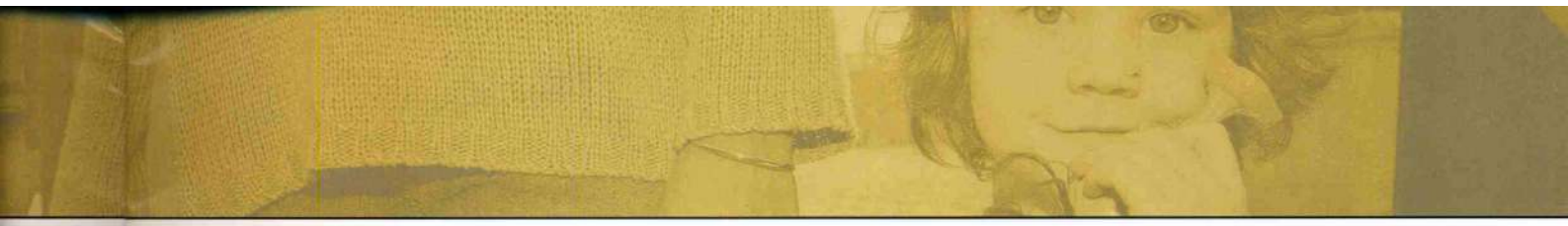
Firstly Gallions has established a **Community Safety Team** to analyse local needs and problems relating to anti-social behaviour and nuisance. The team develops initiatives aimed at reducing crime and works to build effective partnerships with service providers across the two boroughs.

Due to the unique nature of the Thamesmead area, straddling the boundary of two borough councils and their respective police forces, Gallions has clearly recognised the need to develop strong links with Bexley and Greenwich and address the disparity of service provision that has occurred in the past. To ensure an improved sense of safety and security across the area, it is essential that we work together with both boroughs and involve the community in addressing tackling the main issues that concern them.

with Greenwich Council, SRB4 and the Government. The **Police Motorcycle project** and the pilot **Neighbourhood Warden scheme** are seen very much as starting points for further joint initiatives with both Bexley and Greenwich, as well as other agencies that have a significant stake in the future of Thamesmead.

Neighbourhood Wardens

Gallions was successful in securing Government funding for a pilot Neighbourhood Warden Scheme to cover the Thamesmead Moorings, Waterfield and Eynsham areas. Greenwich Council also agreed to provide matched funding for the project, which was developed in partnership with the borough.



Wardens will be on patrol in the areas between 10am and 10pm to help reduce the incidence of crime and antisocial behaviour, improve the environment, develop community links and act as points of contact for local people to share their concerns. If the project is successful, we hope to expand the scheme across the area.





Thamesmead, Abbey Wood and Plumstead Community Safety Partnership

This local partnership has been set up to help Gallions and statutory, voluntary and community partners in Thamesmead and the surrounding area to develop initiatives aimed at environmental and community safety issues.

It is hoped that this forum will enable us to build on the partnership work that we have already begun. Examples of the ongoing work include a proposal to the Bridge House Estates Golden Jubilee Grant fund for an Enviro-crime Education Co-ordinator. If this bid is successful, we will employ a co-ordinator to build on the Environmental Rangers project involving primary school children. The project will focus on providing schools with advice, training and educational materials that will help younger children to develop awareness of environmental issues and the effects of antisocial behaviour on the community. This will be another example of Bexley and Greenwich Councils working in direct partnership with Gallions to tackle issues across the whole area.

Antisocial Behaviour – a strategy for the future

The Community Safety Team is currently reviewing its approach to antisocial behaviour, crime and nuisance. These problems are constantly highlighted as a key priority for residents in Thamesmead. Over the coming months, we will be developing more robust measures to tackle these problems, and are committed to pursuing all available options to combat socially unacceptable and criminal activities. We are working closely with the police, community and other agencies to adopt cohesive strategies in this area. We are particularly keen to involve residents in resolving the problems that they face, and will be seeking to set up community based, problem-solving groups across the area.



What to expect

We hope to continue to attract inward investment of grants and funding aimed at quality-of-life issues. We are actively assessing the results of current initiatives and the benefits they may bring to the whole of Thamesmead in the future. Gallions clearly recognises the need to develop strong partnership links if we are to make Thamesmead a safe, clean and healthy place to live. We are committed to developing the methods and resources needed for effective cross-borough working between local authorities and the police, as well as expanding positive projects to other parts of the area.

Advice and support

Community Renewal staff have been on hand throughout the year to provide advice and support to local groups and residents. Some of the groups we have worked with and supported are Four Legged Friends, Tavy Bridge Focus Group, Greenwich Volunteers, Tavy Bridge Club, Crossways Gym, Thamesmead YAP and Tavy Bridge Playgroup. Other organisations such as Trust Thamesmead, Family Services Unit, Respond and Age Concern have helped us to develop a work programme which reflects the known needs of the Thamesmead community.

Community Chest

We have established a Community Chest, which provides small grants of up to £500 for Gallions residents to fund community-based initiatives.

Local Links

We have been working closely with local partners, Greenwich and Bexley Council staff and regional agencies to ensure that Thamesmead benefits from regeneration funding and initiatives.

Employment and Training

We are working with Greenwich Local Labour and Business to provide up to 10 Intermediate Labour Market places. These will give unemployed residents the opportunity to gain nine months' paid work experience and relevant training.

Community Renewal staff will set up a comprehensive training and support programme for the tenants who are moving into new homes in the EcoPark. This will include capacity building, recycling and energy saving ideas to enable the tenants to make the most of their environmentally friendly homes.

We will continue to encourage local people to apply for jobs with Gallions.

inclusiveness and *community*

Neighbourhood Wardens Pre-Recruitment Courses

To encourage local people to apply for Neighbourhood Warden posts, Gallions worked with Community Network Training on the recruitment process. Over 130 people attended a series of information sessions and over 40 signed up for a week-long pre-recruitment course – a much greater response than we had hoped for. Greenwich's Neighbourhood Renewal Team kindly helped to fund one of the courses as a number of those attending were from the Eynsham and Abbeywood area. Six of the seven wardens recruited are local people who went through the pre-recruitment process.

Community Support

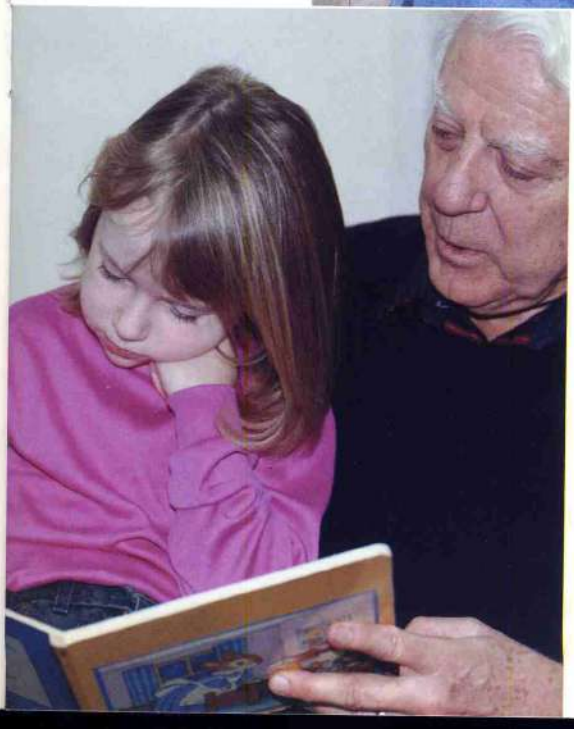
We are developing a scheme to provide a 'handy person' service for our elderly and vulnerable residents. We will work closely with health professionals in Thamesmead, and we are actively seeking funding to employ a Black and Minority Ethnic community worker to enable us to engage with hard-to-reach groups.

We are supporting residents at Tavy Bridge who are holding a conservation day to help clean up Southmere Lake and explore ideas to protect the local wildlife. We will work to engage residents in the tree planting which is proposed as part of the Trees for Thamesmead project. We will continue to be on hand to support residents who have community project ideas throughout the year.



ty renewal





older persons' strategy

Gallions Housing Association recognises that changing demographic and social trends are shaping the nature of provision for older people across housing, support, health and care services. Gallions is committed to working towards maintaining and improving the quality of life for older people in Thamesmead, by ensuring that a good range of services and facilities is available to meet their needs. The Older Persons Strategy has been developed to ensure that Gallions can offer an truly comprehensive service to older people in Thamesmead.

Gallions is committed to working towards maintaining and improving the quality of life for older people in Thamesmead

Key Objectives of the Strategy

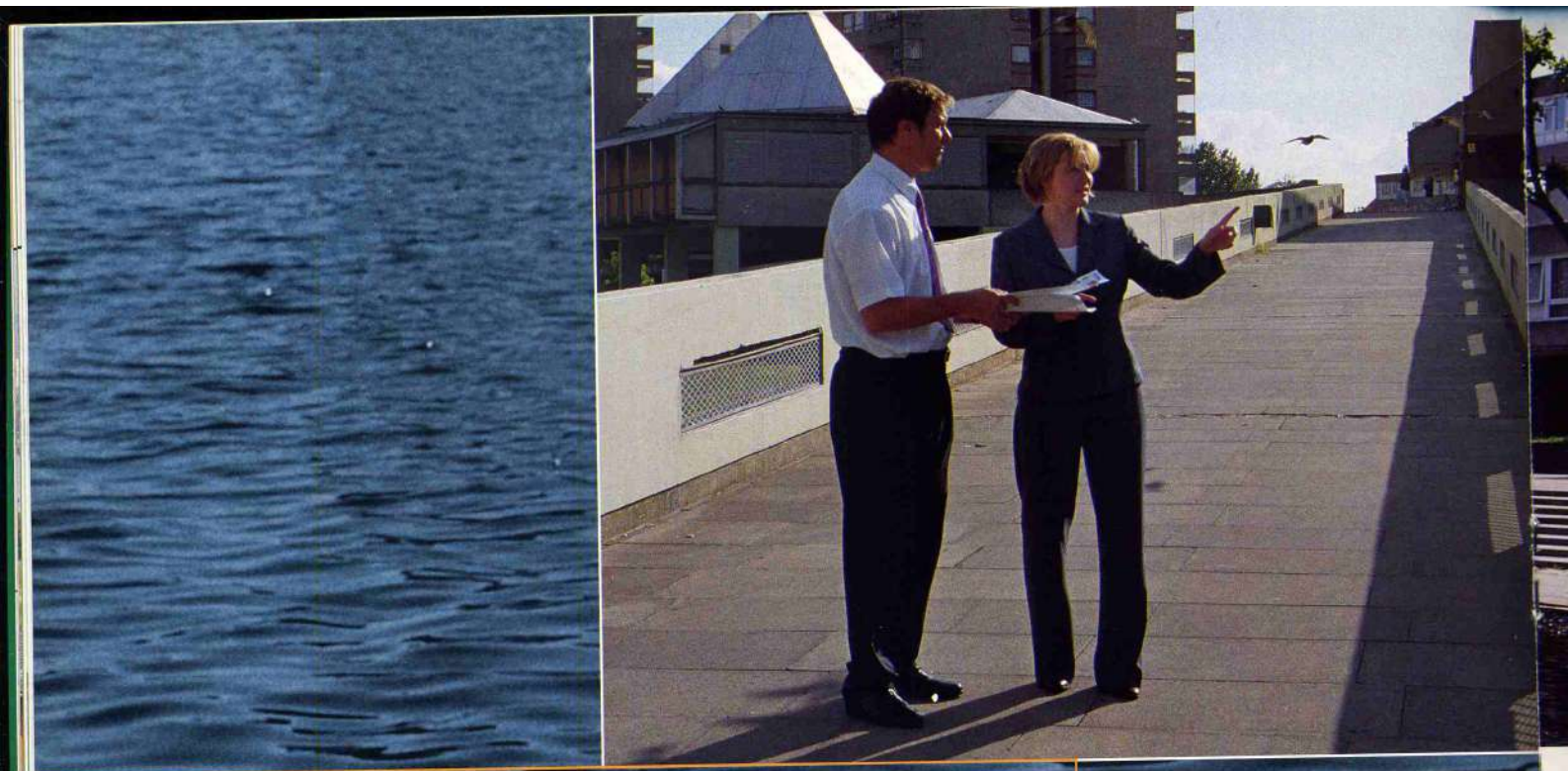
To achieve this vision, a wide range of services and facilities will be made available to older people in Thamesmead, either by Gallions or by others. Gallions will take steps to ensure that the following seven objectives are met, and that they are equally available to all older people, taking into the account the special requirements of minority and vulnerable groups:.





- To provide a choice of accommodation
- To provide homes that are well-maintained and suitable for the needs of the individual tenant or leaseholder
- To continually work to improve safety and security in the home and in Thamesmead more generally
- To ensure good access to home care and health services
- To ensure access to low-level support services, such as cleaning, shopping, gardening and general handyperson services
- To facilitate easy access to social activities
- To facilitate the provision of opportunities to learn and to develop new skills.





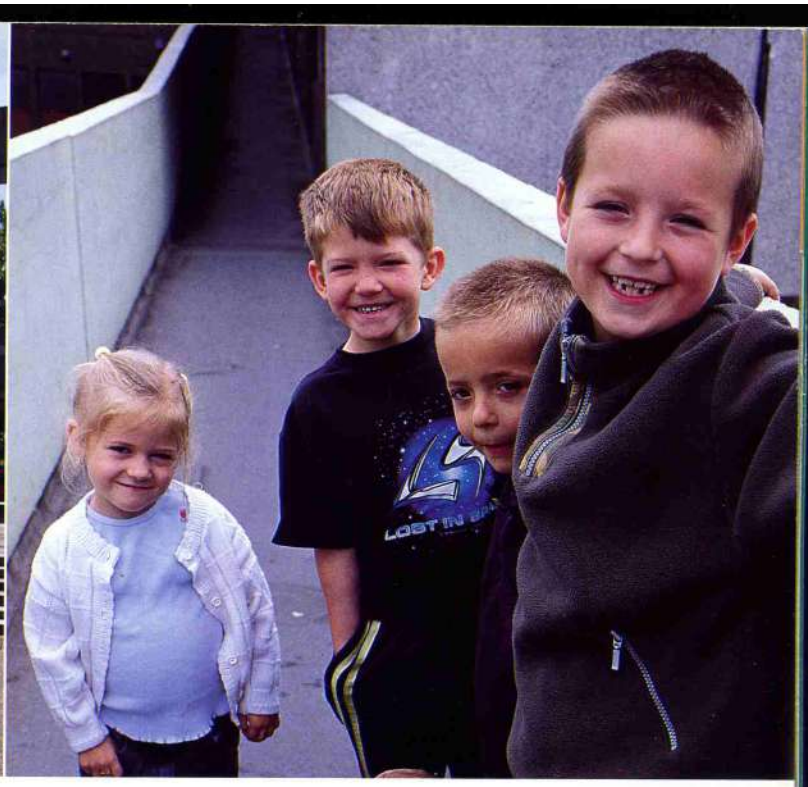
the Tavy Bridge Regeneration Project

What has happened so far

Gallions Housing Association has begun detailed consultation on the regeneration proposals for Tavy Bridge. SLD Architects have been appointed as both architects and project managers for the scheme, and they have been working with Gallions staff, local residents and stakeholders to develop regeneration proposals and ideas.

In the summer of 2001, over 500 residents in and around Tavy Bridge returned a detailed questionnaire on what they wanted to happen. The vast majority of people were in favour of the proposals to demolish the deck over the car park, improve the shops, provide better facilities for local people (including young people) and, of course, generally to improve the appearance of the Tavy Bridge area.





Continuing Consultation

In November 2001, a focus group was established, consisting of people who had shown an interest in getting involved. This group has met regularly since then, and all residents in the Tavy Bridge area are invited to attend the meetings. A core group of local people is actively involved in developing the plans for Tavy Bridge, and they have displayed a keen and positive interest in working together to improve their homes and environment. This informal group has identified a number of priority improvements for Tavy Bridge, discussed design issues and looked at how space is currently used. Residents are kept informed of progress through a regular newsletter, and the focus group is planning lots of different ways to keep people informed about the project.



Good News!

Gallions Housing Association and the Tavy Bridge focus group were successful in attracting £114,750 of Single Regeneration Budget Funding for a series of quick initiatives to improve community safety in the area. This money has come from the Abbey Wood and Thamesmead Single Regeneration Budget programme. The application was submitted in direct response to key concerns raised by residents about Tavy Bridge. Improvements can now be made to the lighting, security and environment in and around Tavy Bridge. New seating, rubbish bins and a graffiti-removing machine have also been purchased.

What happens next?

We have put together a consultation document which includes challenges and solutions, new opportunities, redevelopment proposals, a financial appraisal, risk/action plans and key aims for the Tavy Bridge regeneration project. This will be used to consult residents and organisations throughout 2002/3.

best value and partnering

Best Value is a government-backed initiative that requires local authorities and housing associations to look closely at how they provide services to their customers. They must examine whether their services meet the needs of their customers, and whether they are provided cost-effectively and efficiently. All areas of the Association's work have to be examined within five years in a series of comprehensive service reviews. Reviews are carried out using the principle of the four C's: Consult, Challenge, Compare and Compete.





Consult, Challenge, Compare and Compete

As required by the Association's regulator, the Housing Corporation, Gallions has drawn up a five-year Best Value Performance Plan that was approved by the Board in October 2001. The Plan sets out priorities for the service reviews based on feedback gained as part of a customer satisfaction survey. The Plan outlines Gallions' commitment to:

- Provide the highest standards of open and publicly accountable management for all residents
- Secure the best possible conditions for everyone who lives in Thamesmead to lead a high-quality life
- Encourage residents to fully exercise their rights and responsibilities
- Focus on our citizens and secure the quality services they require
- Ensure that all our staff are given opportunities for development through training, appraisal, respect and support.
- Act in an effective manner and ensure our objectives are met
- Maximise access to our services for people with disabilities or other forms of disadvantage
- Ensure that the principle of sustainability is followed in all the Association's policy and decision making
- Ensure our services are continuously improving, and implement ways to measure progress in that respect.

The first comprehensive service review to be carried out under the plan, Estate Services, got under way in November 2001. This very wide-ranging review, which covers responsive repairs, cyclical maintenance, improvements & major works, aids & adaptations and stock condition, is due to be completed in the first quarter of 2003. As part of the review, we will consult with our customers in a variety of ways, and report back the results in due course.

As part of its commitment to Best Value and improving customer services, Gallions is keen to enter into long term partnerships with its key suppliers and service providers. We believe that these relationships can benefit both parties and improve levels of service for our customers, while containing or reducing costs. During the last year, Gallions has cemented a seven-year partnering arrangement with its IT service provider (Sovereign Business Integration PLC) for the provision of a fully managed Information Systems facility. We have also entered into a partnering arrangement with our principal software supplier (Orchard Information Systems Limited). The provision of a stable, robust and leading-edge IT system is seen as a key element in enabling us to provide efficient and cost-effective services to our customers.

More recently, Gallions has selected a single partner contractor to handle all responsive and void repairs. We will be working with the contractor (Axis Europe PLC) over the coming months to ensure that the way these services are provided meets our customers' needs. As part of this process we will be consulting with our customers on a wide range of issues related to our repairs service.

We are presently exploring ways of developing a partnering arrangement with our legal service providers.

perception study

In December 2001, Gallions commissioned a study to examine the perceptions of the Association held by key organisations. The interviewees represented a cross section of Gallions Housing Association's professional contacts. They consisted of chief executives and senior officers from funding bodies, the Housing Corporation, local authorities, partner organisations/community groups, the media, contractors, consultants and Registered Social Landlords (RSLs). All responses were given on a confidential basis.

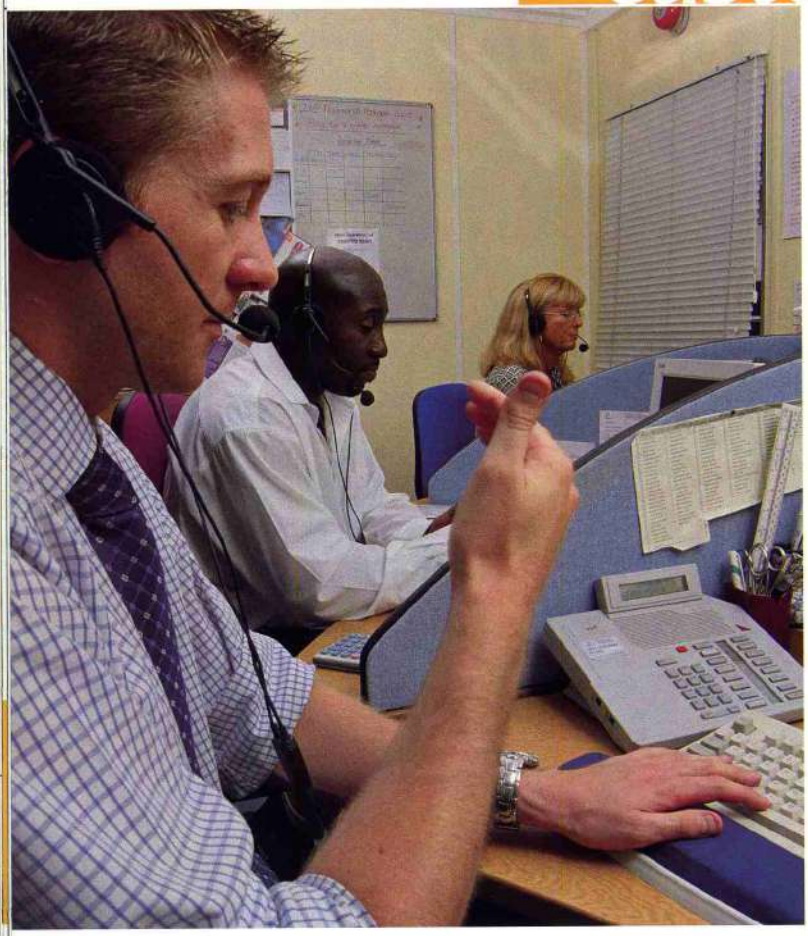
The Association is perceived across a wide range of organisations as:

- The new leaders of housing in Thamesmead
- An organisation that has undergone massive restructuring or re-organisation in the last 18 months
- Excellent at housing management and community initiatives
- Innovative and ambitious
- Demonstrating an expertise for development.

Gallions Housing Association is generally well regarded. Most people questioned felt it had come a long way in the short time since formation, and that during that time it has dealt well with the restructuring of the organisation. It was rated the leader out of the RSLs for Housing Management and was considered an innovative and ambitious RSL.



customer *services*



Last year's Annual Report described new plans to improve customer services in Thamesmead. This year we can report on what has been achieved and how we can build on those developments for the future.

Customer Response Centre

The idea for the Customer Response Centre came about following a customer survey which was distributed to all our residents in 2000. It was designed to help Gallions provide the best possible service for our residents.

In the next year we aim to meet a performance standard of answering 90% of all calls within 15 seconds

The Response Centre began with four staff taking calls on repairs and rent arrears. There have been many improvements since then:

The Centre now handles many more service issues, such as nuisance, buying your property (right to buy), service charges, rehousing, garages and all switchboard calls.

The Response Centre doesn't only take calls, but is also involved in dealing with them effectively. Our team of trained advisers can answer residents' enquiries on these subjects, and will only need to refer problems to a specialist at a much later stage.

This also allows our specialist staff, such as Housing Co-ordinators, to be a visible presence out on the estate rather than answering the telephone.

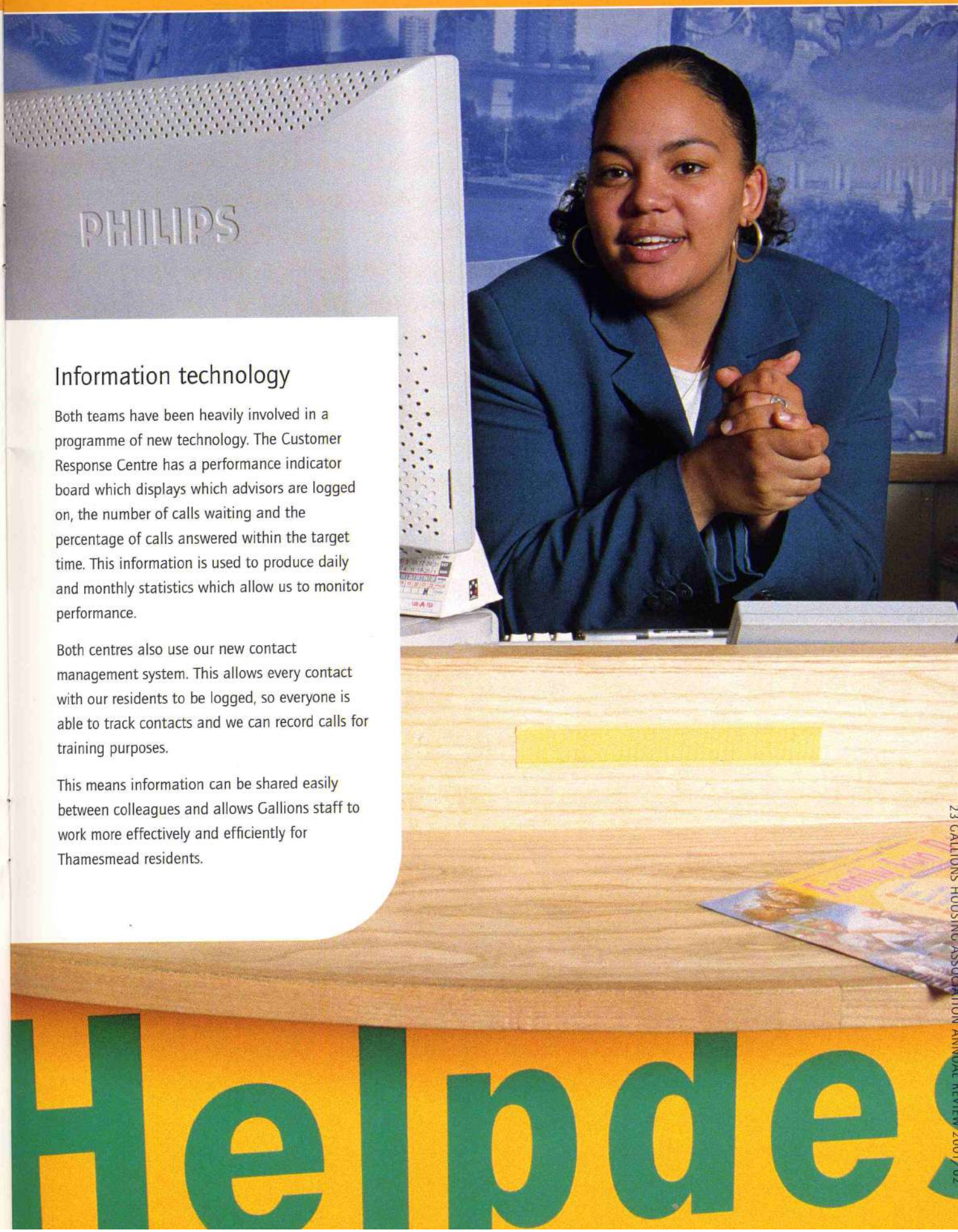
Our Team has recently expanded from four to eight dedicated, trained advisers and they have been located in a specially designed office space. The new staff were recruited particularly for their customer service skills and experience. We have received a great deal of praise for the quality of help and advice that this team is now able to provide.
Our aim for the coming year is to improve our performance levels in the Response Centre. Between January and June this year, 55,823 calls were received – these were dealt with efficiently, but we are striving to build upon this success. In the next year we aim to meet a performance standard of answering 90% of all calls within 15 seconds.

Customer Services Centre

This year has seen us build on the successful introduction of the Customer Services Centre in 2001. Despite some significant staff changes, we have continued to expand our staff's knowledge and skills so that they are able to deal with over 90% of all visitors to the centre themselves, rather than call on the time of the specialists.

Having one team leader managing both this and the Customer Response Team has lead to some innovative cross-working and the sharing of skills and knowledge.

There have been improvements to the physical environment too, with an additional interview room built and a display of performance indicators on a screen in reception. There is also a computer available in our reception area for residents to browse our web site and send emails to staff.



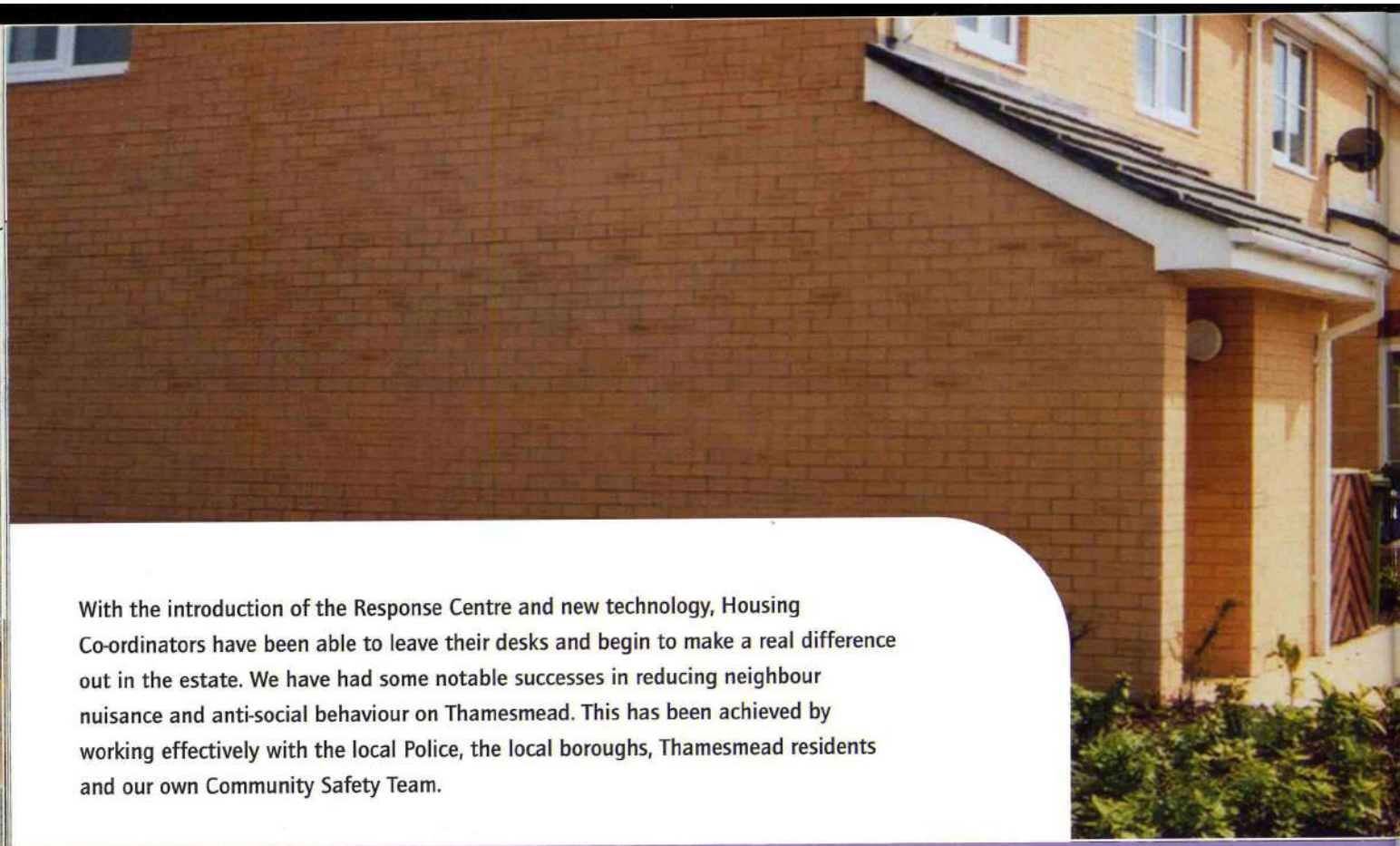
Information technology

Both teams have been heavily involved in a programme of new technology. The Customer Response Centre has a performance indicator board which displays which advisors are logged on, the number of calls waiting and the percentage of calls answered within the target time. This information is used to produce daily and monthly statistics which allow us to monitor performance.

Both centres also use our new contact management system. This allows every contact with our residents to be logged, so everyone is able to track contacts and we can record calls for training purposes.

This means information can be shared easily between colleagues and allows Gallions staff to work more effectively and efficiently for Thamesmead residents.

Helpde



With the introduction of the Response Centre and new technology, Housing Co-ordinators have been able to leave their desks and begin to make a real difference out in the estate. We have had some notable successes in reducing neighbour nuisance and anti-social behaviour on Thamesmead. This has been achieved by working effectively with the local Police, the local boroughs, Thamesmead residents and our own Community Safety Team.

Housing *co-ordinators*

Homeowners

As promised in the last Annual Review, a dedicated team has been created to handle enquiries from Thamesmead Homeowners and residents wanting to exercise their right to buy.

A leaseholder forum has been set up to represent the views of Gallions leaseholders, and successful consultations have taken place with leaseholders on improvements to their blocks. Gallions also expects to have its first shared ownership properties available in 2002/3.

Rehousing

As last year's report showed, there have been major changes in the way we allocate property since we became a Housing Association in June 2000.

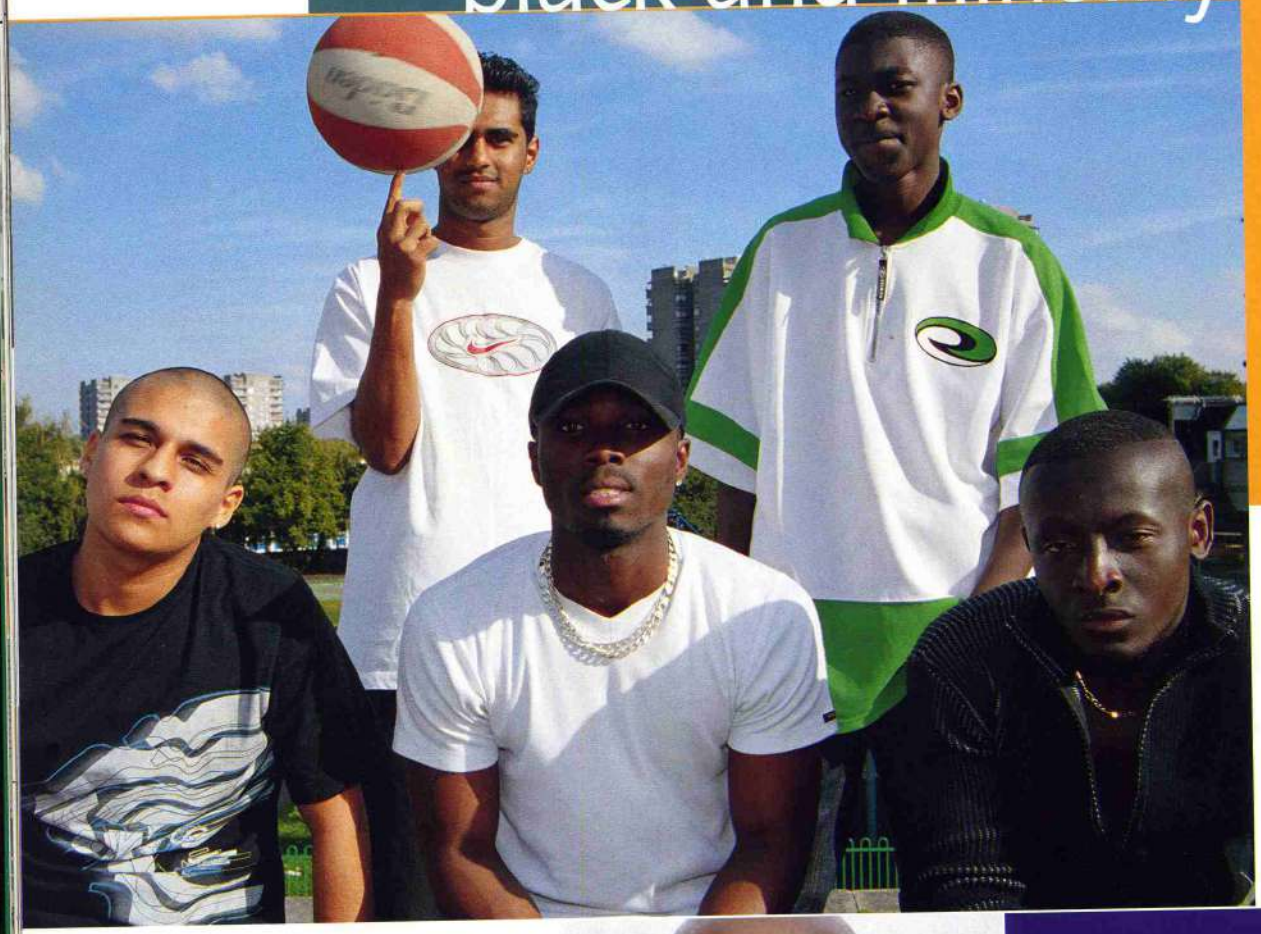
Most properties allocated last year (including 30 new build properties) were through the nomination agreements with the local Boroughs.

We have also drastically reduced the amount of time our properties are left empty and we now have a void turnaround time of less than four weeks. This has been achieved through a lot of hard work by the rehousing team and our building services staff, as well as improved relationships with the Boroughs and our contractors.

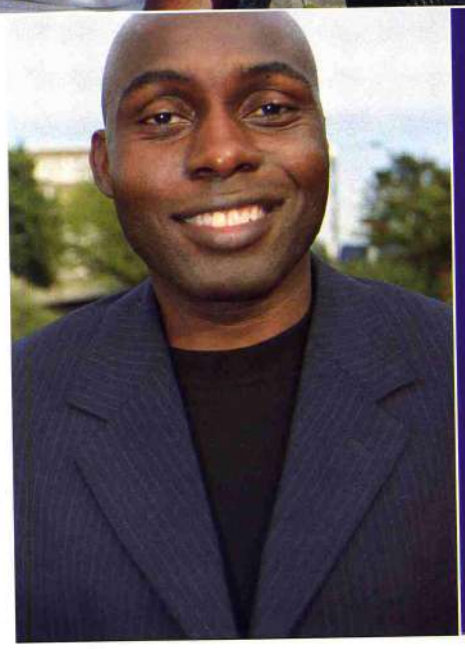

BATTERY ROAD SE20

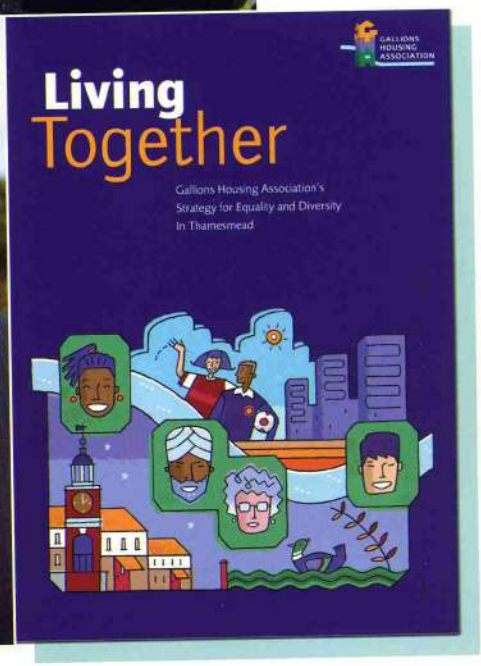


black and minority ethnic



Gallions Housing Association is working to promote a welcoming, vibrant, confident and diverse community in Thamesmead where there is mutual respect for background, race, religion and culture





strategy

Thamesmead is a diverse community.

The latest customer survey data shows that Thamesmead's population is 81% White, 13% Black, 1% Asian, 2% Southeast Asian and 1% other communities. We are keenly awaiting the outcome from the 2001 census and our own tenancy audit, both of which will provide very accurate data in greater detail than is currently available.

When looking at the way our services are delivered to different communities there are no significant differences. The overall picture is of a diverse community, living together and receiving a consistent service from Gallions.



Towards the end of 2001/2002, Gallions' Board commissioned a project to thoroughly review Gallions' existing Black and Minority Ethnic strategy. The project was led by Gallions Board member and tenant representative Tokky Ademoyero, and resulted in a new strategy, 'Living Together'. Copies of this public document are available from Gallions.

The strategy takes account of the recommendations of the Race and Housing Inquiry 'Challenge Report' 2002 and the NHF's Race Equality Code of Practice for Housing Associations (May 2002).

'Living Together' was approved and formally adopted by Gallions Board in June 2002, with the following public statement of commitment.

Gallions Housing Association is working to promote a welcoming, vibrant, confident and diverse community in Thamesmead where there is mutual respect for background, race, religion and culture.

The strategy sets firm objectives and lays out a plan of action to achieve them. In summary, these objectives address:

- the composition of the Board
- customer satisfaction levels
- equal access to services (including resident and community involvement)
- lettings plan and the management of racial incidents.

The strategy also deals with Gallions' role as employer of a representative and diverse staff team, and what is expected from contractors.

The strategy is all about making a real difference. It takes a practical approach with the aim of looking at, and where necessary improving, Gallions performance in every aspect of its operation and sphere of influence.

As part of the strategy, the Equality and Diversity Panel was set up, with a membership that represents the range of interests in the Thamesmead community. The Panel's main responsibility will be to monitor progress against the strategy and plan of action, and it will also be a channel of communication between the community and Gallions.

resident participation



GALLIONS RESIDENTS' BOARD

GRB MEMBERS LEFT TO RIGHT

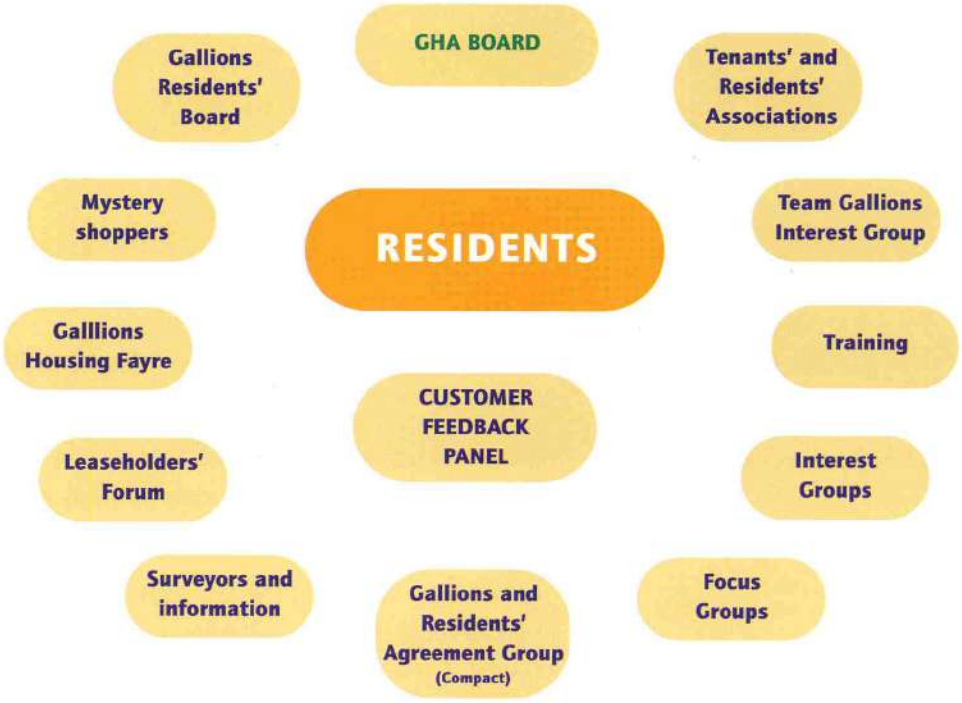
Jim Malley
Joanne Barnard & Daughter
Alan Church
Carol Downes
Ray Hill
Olive Williams
Sam Robinson
Val Killman
Wendy Bradbury
Joyce Couchman
Tom Nash
Liz Gardiner
Terry Graves
Meg Cherney
Graham Horton
Keeley Savill
Paula Nash
David Scott
Don Tidey
Pauline Robinson
Pauline Oates

The Tenant Participation Team has been increased in size to enabe new ways of increasing the involvement of residents. We want residents to get involved at a level that suits them.

In the last year there have also been major changes in the ways Gallions has sought to involve and consult residents. The Gallions Residents Board (GRB) has been set up, replacing the three area-based Estate Management Boards. The GRB gives representation to tenants and leaseholders on the Board of Gallions Housing Association, and successful elections were held in July 2002.

Resident Involvement Activities

The Resident Involvement Activities chart illustrates the range of ways that Gallions consults, involves and supports residents who want to have a say in the services we provide. These activities range from surveys to setting up Interest Groups on issues that concern residents. Over the last year we have set up a 'Mystery Shopper' scheme, and we have used focus groups to consult on issues as varied as the Older Persons Strategy and Neighbourhood Wardens.



Support and Training

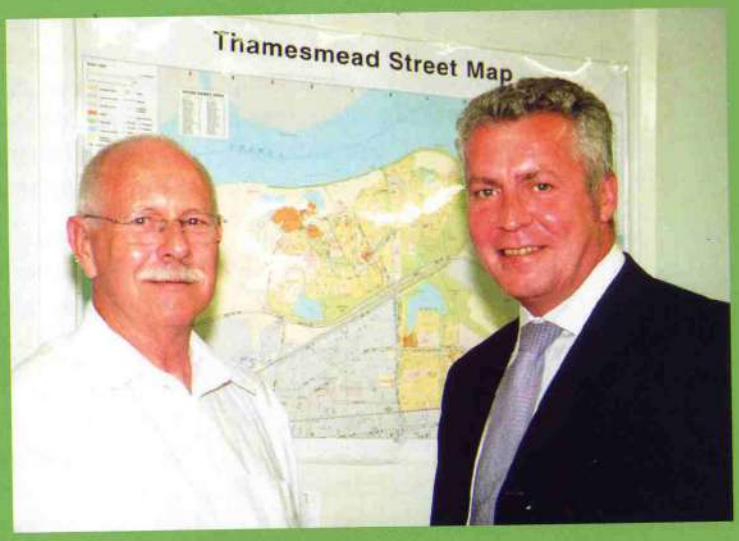
We have continued to support our Tenants and Residents Associations (TRAs), of which there are currently three. All of Gallions' Housing Co-ordinators have now received training on how to support Tenants and Residents Associations.

Gallions' Tenant Participation Team has organised a free training programme for residents during the last year, aimed at helping them to represent their community and run their groups effectively.

Gallions has also been working in partnership with residents to write the Gallions and Resident Participation Agreement. This negotiated agreement will set out promises on how residents can influence our services in the future. Residents, staff and the Gallions Board will all sign up to the agreement.

Monitor and Measure

Gallions has started to monitor how effectively we consult residents and whether the residents we consult are representative of the wider community. We have developed performance indicators for Resident Involvement that will help us to measure this, and the results will be reported back to residents.



Gallions Housing Association and the Gallions Residents Board (GRB) have continued to promote the Tenants Resource Centre as a resource for the community. This year we recruited a part-time worker to help with the running of the Centre and to deal with GRB administration.
The Tenant Participation Team has surveyed residents on how they want to be involved in future, and the sorts of issues that interest them. All residents who replied to our survey have agreed to join our new Customer Feedback Panel. We used this panel to form a Team Gallions Interest Group, where residents are helping Team Gallions to improve their service by setting future service standards.
In the coming year, we are looking forward to establishing the Leaseholders' Forum and an Area Representative Scheme. We will also use the Customer Feedback Panel to create more Interest Groups and Focus Groups, to make sure that everyone who wants to have a say can do so.

performance *indicators*

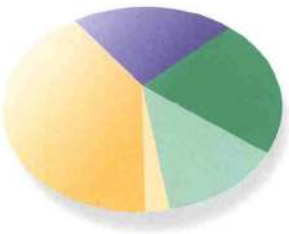
Stock

The number of units managed by Gallions at the end of 2001/02 was 4,484 compared to 4,497 the previous year. During the year 30 new properties were built, but 43 properties were sold under the Right to Buy scheme, giving a net reduction in stock of 13 units.

The make up of the stock remained much the same as last year as follows:

Bedsits	90	(2%)
One-bed units	1813	(40%)
Two-bed units	1015	(23%)
Three-bed units	1011	(22%)
Four-bed and larger units	555	(12%)

53% of Gallions' units are in the London Borough of Bexley and 47% in the London Borough of Greenwich.



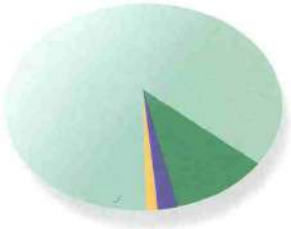
90 Bedsits 2%
1813 One-bed units 40%
1015 Two-bed units 23%
1011 Three-bed units 22%
555 Four-bed and larger units 12%

Rent

In April 2001, secure rents were increased up to the levels last registered by the Rent Officer in 1999. This equated to an overall increase of 7.4%. At the same time assured rents were increased for the first time in five years by £1.68 per week across the board, giving an average increase of 2.1%.

The total rent roll for the year was £17.2 million, which was made up as:

Rent	87%
Service charges	10%
Fuel charges	1%
Other charges (garages/repairs)	2%



Rent 87%
Service charges 10%
Fuel charges 1%
Other charges (garage repairs) 2%

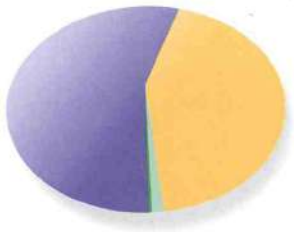
Rent Arrears

Gross rent arrears increased from £996K last year to £1,001K at the end of this year, an increase of £5K (0.5%). However, after allowing for outstanding housing benefit payments from the Local Authorities there was a reduction in net rent arrears from £790K to £732K, a reduction of £58K (7%). It is Gallions' policy to pursue rent arrears fairly but vigorously, and during the year we unfortunately had to evict 48 tenants compared to 29 last year.

Waiting List

The waiting list for external applicants is currently closed due the nomination agreements with the two Local Authorities. The number of applicants on the waiting list as at the end of the year was 579 compared to 811 last year. These applicants can be broken down as follows.

External Applicants	227	39%
Internal Transfers	291	50%
Thamesmead Residents	52	9%
Others	9	2%

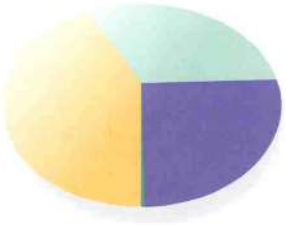


227 External Applicants 39%
291 Internal Transfers 50%
52 Thamesmead Residents 9%
9 Others 2%

Lettings

There were 422 new lettings in the year compared to 418 last year. These can be broken down as follows:

136 Applicants	32%
107 Transfers/Exchanges	25%
175 Local Authority Nominations	42%
4 Homes	1%



136 Applicants 32%
107 Transfers/Exchanges 25%
175 Local Authority Nominations 42%
4 Homes 1%

Empty Properties

The average number of properties empty each month rose from 32 last year to 39 this year. However, the last two months of the year saw this figure fall to an average of 21. As a percentage of stock, the number of empty properties rose from 0.71% to 0.87%.

The average time taken to re-let empty properties also rose from 4.52 weeks to 5.56 weeks, but again there was an improvement towards the end of the year, which saw the period fall to 3.28 weeks.

There were two reasons for the increase in empty properties and re-let periods – delays in receiving nominations from the Local Authorities and a fall off in performance by contractors carrying out refurbishment work. Both of these problems have been addressed.

As a result of these increases the amount of rent lost due to empty properties rose from 1.13% last year to 1.31%.

Repairs

The number of repair jobs raised in the year was the same as last year at over 23,000, at a cost of £2.36 million. A new way of measuring customer satisfaction with repairs was introduced during the year. This resulted in an overall satisfaction level of 91%, which was disappointingly low. A major factor in the fall-off in satisfaction was the poor performance of some contractors not completing repairs on the first visit and within the target dates set by Gallions. This led to the suspension of one contractor.

Gallions' performance target on day-to-day repairs was 96%. This was achieved by two of our main contractors, but the remaining two were well below target, giving the following overall performance levels:

Emergency Repairs	95%
Urgent Repairs	87%
Routine Repairs	82%



Emergency repairs 95%
Urgent repairs 87%
Routine repairs 82%

Planned Maintenance

Expenditure on planned maintenance during the year amounted to £2.5 million and covered more than 50 different projects. Some of the projects were:

Roof Renewals	£211K
New Block Lighting	£ 40K
Bridge & Staircase Maintenance	£396K
External Painting	£386K
New Kitchens	£140K
EMB Environmental Projects	£397K
CCTV	£ 74K
Rewiring Homes	£ 50K
Elderly Persons Decorating Scheme	£ 54K

Equal Opportunities

The introduction of nomination agreements with the two Local Authorities means that we have no control over the number of Black and Minority Ethnic nominees re-housed. With regard to applicants re-housed from Gallions waiting list these are based on a points system, which works strictly on a 'top of the list' basis and does not differentiate between ethnic groups. Nonetheless, the number of Gallions applicants re-housed by ethnic group is well within the ethnic groups' representation in the Thamesmead area.

financial summary

The Balance Sheet and Income and Expenditure Account for the financial year are shown below. Detailed financial statements can be obtained by contacting the Association

INCOME AND EXPENDITURE ACCOUNT for the year ended 31 MARCH 2002

	Group		Association	
	2002	11 months ended 31 March 2001	2002	11 months ended 31 March 2001
	£000	£000	£000	£000
Turnover				
Group and share of joint venture	31,376	22,871	19,501	18,052
Less: Share of joint venture turnover – Tilfen Land	(11,825)	(4,696)		-
Group turnover	19,551	18,175	19,501	18,052
Operating costs	(17,399)	(16,712)	(17,307)	(16,597)
OPERATING SURPLUS	2,152	1,463	2,194	1,455
Share of operating surplus in joint venture	4,517	1,102	-	-
Total operating surplus including share of joint venture	**6,669**	**2,565**	**2,194**	**1,455**
Surplus on sale of fixed assets	708	656	708	656
Surplus on ordinary activities before interest	7,377	3,221	2,902	2,111
Interest receivable	696	961	517	799
Interest payable	(1,066)	(855)	(1,066)	(855)
Surplus on ordinary activities before taxation	7,007	3,327	2,353	2,055
Taxation (charge)/credit on surplus on ordinary activities – share of tax of joint venture	(91)	1,632	-	-
RETAINED SURPLUS FOR THE PERIOD	6,916	4,959	2,353	2,055

The operating surplus for the period arises from the Group and Association's continuing operations.

BALANCE SHEET as at 31 MARCH 2002

	Group		Association	
	2002	11 months ended 31 March 2001	2002	11 months ended 31 March 2001
	£000	£000	£000	£000
Fixed assets				
Housing properties at cost less depreciation	87,220	83,087	87,220	83,087
Other tangible assets	3,409	2,548	3,363	2,461
Investments	-	-	17,297	17,297
Investments in joint venture				
Share of gross assets	35,660	29,673	-	-
Share of gross liabilities	(6,429)	(5,707)	-	-
	119,860	109,601	107,880	102,845
CURRENT ASSETS				
Stocks	-	44	-	44
Debtors	1,481	1,166	1,514	1,130
Cash at bank and in hand	8,465	16,248	8,454	16,246
	9,946	17,458	9,968	17,420
Creditors: amounts falling due within one year	(6,236)	(4,294)	(6,244)	(4,243)
NET CURRENT ASSETS	3,710	13,164	3,724	13,177
TOTAL ASSETS LESS CURRENT LIABILITIES	123,570	122,765	111,604	116,022
Creditors: amounts falling due after more than one year	14,300	15,000	14,300	15,000
PROVISION FOR LIABILITIES AND CHARGES	2,239	8,310	2,239	8,310
CAPITAL AND RESERVES				
Share capital	-	-	-	-
Revenue reserves	14,794	6,344	7,327	3,440
Revaluation reserve	1,292	632	-	-
Negative goodwill	90,945	92,479	87,738	89,272
	123,570	122,765	111,604	116,022

Approved by the Management Board on 19 September 2002

Graham Horton *Acting Chair of the Board*

Ibironke Adeagbo *Honorary Treasurer*

Averyl Richards *Secretary*

board of *governors*

Management Board 2001/02

Tenants and Charge-payers	Local Authority Nominees	Independent Board Members
Tokky Ademoyero	John Fahy	Ronke Adeagbo
Wendy Bradbury	Mike French	William Ekinu
Liz Gardener	Graham Holland	Chris Garlick
Graham Horton	Peter Kotz	Audrey Mitchell
Sam Robinson		Keith Wrate
Ken Sealey		

Board Member Attendance



Local authorities 69%

Tenants 73%

Independents 74%

Obligations of Board Members

A Board member's obligations include:

- to uphold the Association's core policies, including those for Equal Opportunities
- to uphold the values and objectives of the Association
- to contribute to a shared responsibility for the Board's decisions
- to prepare for and attend meetings, training and other events of the Association
- to represent the Association on occasions
- to declare any relevant interests
- to respect confidentiality of information
- to uphold the Code of Governance of the National Federation of Housing Associations.

No individual can stand for, or remain a member of, the Association or Board if they have arrears or any other dispute with the Association, unless they have entered into a satisfactory arrangement for clearing those arrears or resolving the dispute.

Board and Committee Structure

In September 2001 the Board revised is Committee structure to form four Committees – Audit, Finance, Operations and Executive. These provide a governance structure more in line with the current needs of the Association. Each Committee's brief is to examine in detail the policy and performance issues within its area. Board members with the appropriate skills and experience were appointed to each of the Committees. In order to involve engage Board members more deeply, a system of Board 'champions' for particular subjects or areas was introduced, along with one-off working groups for particular subjects. The structure of the Committees is shown below:



Skills, Qualities and Experience Required of Board Members

It is very important for the Board to ensure that its members have the skills, knowledge and experience to they need to carry out their responsibilities effectively. The recruitment, induction and training of Board members are crucial elements in ensuring the sound governance of the Association.

The Board will ensure that new members are recruited or elected on a systematic and continuous basis and, wherever possible, by open advertisement or consultation with other interested bodies. Members should have relevant skills and experience, and the Board as a whole will seek to reflect the communities within which it works.

The Board considers the balance of skills and experience appropriate to its work, and recruits Board members openly and systematically so as to achieve this balance. At least once each year the Board identifies any skills which will be required for it to meet its responsibilities properly.

The table below shows the skills, qualities and experience that Board members require, and the extent to which they are met by the Board members currently in office and those who are retiring but intend to offer themselves for re-election:

Skills	Training Required	General Knowledge	High level of knowledge and/or experience
The housing needs that the RSL aims to meet	16%	68%	16%
Residents' needs and concerns	19%	63%	19%
Strategic management in a public or private body	28%	34%	38%
General business activities including the management of staff, property and contracts	19%	60%	21%
Finance	22%	48%	30%
Legal matters	21%	79%	0%
Community relations and needs, including equal opportunities	24%	53%	24%
Working with Regulatory bodies and local authorities	11%	73%	16%
Development and building	13%	83%	4%
Public Relations	13%	69%	19%
Management of information technology	21%	71%	7%
Race equality	6%	75%	19%

Method of Election for Tenant and Charge-Payer Board Members

Tenant and Charge-payer Board members shall be drawn from members of Gallions Residents Board who have been elected by the tenants and charge-payers of the Association respectively. They shall be proposed to the Board by the Executive of the GRB.

Any candidate for election to the Board is required to submit a written statement to the Association setting out the reasons for their suitability to be a Board member.

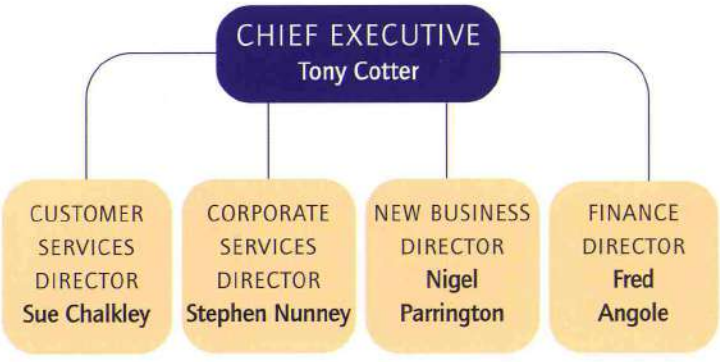
Shareholding Membership Policy

Gallions is committed to maintaining a broadly based shareholding membership to ensure openness and accountability and to encourage greater resident involvement in the management of their homes.
All applicants for membership of the Association should meet at least one of the following criteria:

- a long-term interest in and support for the Association
- the appropriate skills, experience and availability to make a significant contribution to the Association by becoming a member, either at the time of application or in the future
- the commitment and relevant skills and/or experience to make a positive contribution to the Association without becoming an active member
- the applicant is someone who will help improve the representation of local communities within the Association's shareholding
- the applicant is someone who will contribute to a balanced mix within the Association's shareholding.

Compliance with the NHF Code Of Governance
Gallions complies with the National Housing Federation's 2000 Code of Governance 'Competence and Accountability'.

Executive Team



GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION
HARROW MANOR WAY
LONDON SE2 9XH

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